Dylan W. Groves

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Academic Appointments

Assistant Professor, Lafayette College 2023–Present

Education

Ph.D., Political Science, Columbia University 2023
Dissertation: "Media and accountability in Tanzania" (distinction)

M.S., Foreign Service, Georgetown University 2013

B.A., Political Science, University of California at Berkeley 2010

Research

Published & Forthcoming

2026 "The long-term and spillover effects of a radio drama on HIV knowledge, expressed stigma, willingness to disclose, and political priorities: Evidence from a cluster-randomized trial in Tanzania". Dylan W. Groves, Alphoncina Kagaigai, Constantine Manda, Beatrice Montano, Savannah Nivin, Bardia Rahmani, and Donald P. Green. *Social Science & Medicine*.

2026 "The effect of radio dramas on willingness to report intimate partner violence". Kate SantaMaria, Noela Ringo, Kasim Abdallah, Dylan W. Groves, and Brenda Nyambo. *Frontiers in Communication*.

2026 "Media capture in Africa: a case study on Tanzania". Anya Schiffrin, Dylan W. Groves, Marco Kitundu, and Francis Nyonzo. In *The Routledge Handbook of Political Corruption*. Ed. by Paul M. Heywood, Ina Kubbe, and Anna K. Schwickerath. Routledge.

2025 "The persuasive effects of narrative entertainment: a meta-analysis of recent experiments". Bardia Rahmani, Beatrice Montano, Dylan W. Groves, and Donald P. Green. *Behavioural Public Policy*.

2025 "Understanding journalism impact: A multi-dimensional taxonomy for professional, organizational and societal change". Anya Schiffrin, André Corrêa d'Almeida, Lindsay Green-Barber, Adelina Yankova, and Dylan W. Groves. *Journal of Applied Journalism & Media Studies*.

2025 "Better Together: the perceived impact of the ICIJ's Pandora Papers collaboration on journalism and journalists". Anya Schiffrin, Dylan W. Groves, Audrey Hatfield, and Lindsay Green-Barber. *Information, Communication & Society*.

2024 "The Effects of Independent Local Radio on Tanzanian Public Opinion: Evidence from a Planned Natural Experiment". Donald P. Green, Dylan W. Groves, Constantine Manda, Beatrice Montano, and Bardia Rahmani. *The Journal of Politics*.

2023 "Perspective Taking through Partisan Eyes: Cross-National Empathy, Partisanship, and Attitudes toward International Cooperation". Don Casler and Dylan Groves. *The Journal of Politics*.

2023 "A Radio Drama's Effects on Attitudes Toward Early and Forced Marriage: Results From a Field Experiment in Rural Tanzania". Donald P. Green, Dylan W. Groves, Constantine Manda, Beatrice Montano, and Bardia Rahmani. *Comparative Political Studies*.

2023 "Seeing Cattle like a State: Sedentist Assumptions of the Namibian Livestock Identification and Traceability System". Max Mauerman, Venomukona Tjiseua, and Dylan W. Groves. *Nomadic Peoples*.

2022 "Community-based rangeland management in Namibia improves resource governance but not environmental and economic outcomes". D. Layne Coppock, Luke Crowley, Susan L. Durham, Dylan Groves, Julian C. Jamison, Dean Karlan, Brien E. Norton, and R. Douglas Ramsey. *Communications Earth & Environment*.

2021 "A Radio Drama's Effects on HIV Attitudes and Policy Priorities: A Field Experiment in Tanzania". Donald P. Green, Dylan W. Groves, and Constantine Manda. *Health Education & Behavior*.

2020 "The Mismeasurement of Cattle Ownership In Namibia's Northern Communal Areas". Dylan Groves and Venomukona Tjiseua. *Nomadic Peoples*.

2017 "The influence of two levels of debushing in Namibia's thornbush savanna on overall soil fertility, measured through bioassays". I. Zimmermann, M. Nghikembua, D. Shipingana, T. Aron, D. Groves, and L. Marker. *Namibian Journal of Environment*.

Working Papers

The persuasive power of Africa's High Courts: evidence from Tanzania. Salma Emmanuel, Donald P. Green, Dylan W. Groves, Constantine Manda, Bardia Rahmani, Beatrice Montano (*revise and resubmit*).

Uninformed or unmotivated? A field experiment on local leader responsiveness in Tanzania. Dylan W. Groves (*under review*).

A radio drama's effects on environmental protection: experimental evidence from Tanzania. Bardia Rahmani, Dylan W. Groves, Donald P. Green, Beatrice Montano.

Governments respond to local journalism: experimental evidence from Tanzania. Dylan W. Groves.

Party at the courthouse: evidence from Tanzania. Kate SantaMaria, Kasim Abdallah, Brenda Nyambo, Noela Ringo, Dylan W. Groves.

The effect of climate change news on public opinion about the environment: evidence from a lab-in-the-field experiment in Tanzania. Salma Emmanuel, Dylan W. Groves, Alexander Brown, Beatrice Montano, Bardia Rahmani, Donald P. Green.

Religious elite messaging and women's political participation. Bardia Rahmani, Dylan W. Groves, Donald P. Green, Beatrice Montano, Francis N'gatigwa.

Journalism and blame attribution in hegemonic party regimes: evidence from Tanzania. Benjamin Risley, Dylan W. Groves, Zakayo Zakaria.

A radio drama's effects on gender-based violence awareness and responses: experimental evidence from Tanzania. Beatrice Montano, Dylan W. Groves, Donald P. Green, Bardia Rahmani.

What drives household solar adoption in Africa? Athena Wagner, Salma Emmanuel, Dylan W. Groves.

The authority gap: differential effects of judicial and religious elite messages on social policy attitudes in Tanzania. Benjamin Risley, Kate SantaMaria, Dylan W. Groves.

Radio distribution and health information. Savannah Nivin, Alphoncina Kagaigai, Dylan W. Groves.

Narrative entertainment shapes policy priorities: evidence from four field experiments in Tanzania. Donald P. Green, Dylan W. Groves, Constantine Manda, Beatrice Montano, Bardia Rahmani.

Works in Progress

A national-scale field experiment to improve public health services in Tanzania, with Salma Emmanuel, Constantine Manda, and John Marshall.

A national-scale field experiment on radio messaging and family planning in Nigeria, with John Marshall, Mahesh Karra, and Nneka Osalador.

A national-scale field experiment of digital feedback to improve health services, with Robbie Dulin, Pascaline Dupas, Alphoncina Kigaigai, and John Marshall.

Can radio dramas reduce intimate partner violence? Experimental evidence from Rwanda, with Aline Umubyeyi and Donald P. Green.

Leveraging religious leaders to counter human trafficking in rural Tanzania, with Salma Emmanuel and Beatrice Montano.

Grants

2025 Lafayette College: $4,000
Ambitious Impact, One Individual, & Bloom Wellbeing Fund: $90,000 (with Aline Umubyeyi and Donald P. Green)
IPA Intimate Partner Violence Initiative: $50,000 (with Aline Umubyeyi and Donald P. Green)
NOVAH: $55,000 (with Aline Umubyeyi and Donald P. Green)

2024 Fund for International Development: $800,000 (with Alphoncina Kagaigai, Pascaline Dupas, Robbie Dulin, and John Marshall)
Anonymous Donor: $100,000 (with John Marshall, Maggie McConnell, Mahesh Karra, and Nneka Osalador)
Development Innovation Ventures: $1,500,000 (with John Marshall, Maggie McConnell, Mahesh Karra, and Nneka Osalador)
Innovations for Poverty Action Intimate Partner Violence Research Initiative: $110,000 (with John Marshall)

2023 Human Trafficking Research Initiative: $13,000 (with Beatrice Montano and Salma Emmanuel)
New Venture Fund: $208,777 (with John Marshall and Danford Sango)
J-PAL Governance Initiative Pilot Grant: $74,134 (with John Marshall)

2022 Mercury Project: $475,000 (with Tausi Kida, Constantine Manda, and John Marshall)

2019 Columbia University Travel Grant: $3,000
Crime and Violence Initiative Exploratory Grant: $8,000
J-PAL Governance Initiative Pilot Grant: $34,000

2018 J-PAL Governance Initiative Exploratory Grant: $8,000

2017 Millennium Challenge Corporation: ~$2,000,000 (with Dean Karlan and Julian Jamison)

2016 Deans Fellowship, Columbia University

External Affiliations

Innovations for Poverty Action (2013–Present)

Jameel Poverty Action Labs Governance Initiative (2026–Present)

Languages and Skills

Languages: Swahili (Intermediate), Spanish (Beginner)
Statistical skills: ArcGIS, CloudRF, Python (intermediate), QGIS, R, STATA, SurveyCTO

Teaching

African Politics, American Politics, Comparative Politics, International Relations, Media and Politics

Referee Service

American Economic Review: Insights, Journal of Development Economics, Journal of Modern African Studies, Journal of Politics, Nature Social Science

Conferences

2025 Midwestern Political Science Association; Experiments in Government and Politics; Center for the Study of African Economies

2024 Midwestern Political Science Association; African Studies Association; Center for the Study of African Economies

2023 Midwestern Political Science Association; American Political Science Association; African Studies Association

2022 Northeast Workshop in Experimental Political Science (NEWEPS); Duke INCITE; Columbia Experimental Design Workshop; BBC Media Action Conference; UNICEF Conference on Edutainment

2021 American Political Science Association; Midwest Political Science Association; International Studies Association; Political Economy of International Relations

2020 American Political Science Association

2019 Midwestern Political Science Association

2018 Millennium Challenge Corporation Results Endline (Washington DC); Millennium Challenge Corporation Results Endline (Windhoek); Resource Governance Institute (Accra); Geo 4 Dev (UC Berkeley)

2014 Behavioral Economics and Community Resource Management (University of Cologne)

Service

2025 Faculty Advisor, Human Trafficking Initiative

2024–25 Faculty Advisor, GovLab

2023–25 Founder, Global Media Lab

2022–23 Mentor, ESRF scholars training

2020–24 Mentor, Graduate Applications International Network (GAIN)

2018–20 Director, Graduate Student Seminar

2018 Linkages Chair, Columbia Political Science Graduate Student Committee

2017–19 Mentor, New York City Urban Debate League

2010–12 Mentor, Bay Area Urban Debate League

Honors Theses

2026 Victoria Hutchinson, "Drivers of ISIS Recruitment" (Primary Reader)
Alexander Brown, "How Aid Organizations Overcome Aid Blockages" (Primary Reader)
Isabella Tang, "Barriers to Social Reintegration of Human Trafficking Victims" (Primary Reader)
Danielle Archibold, "Legal Frameworks to Promote Corporate Responsibility for GBV Protection" (Primary Reader)

2025 Matthew Olson, "MCMC Sampling of Partially Observed Multivariate Normal Distributions" (Mathematics, Second Reader)
Tara Amidon, "Humanitarian Intervention and the Responsibility to Protect" (Second Reader)
2024 Matwos Tadesse, "Ethnic Identity on Fuel: Dissecting the effect of ethnic federalism in Ethiopia" (Second Reader)